

Name: _____

Date: _____

Australian Curriculum v9.0 Aligned | AC9E6LY04 | Year 6 | Complex Texts, Perspective & Sustained Argument

LEARNING INTENTION

I am learning to analyse complex texts by examining perspective, evaluating evidence and constructing sustained, well-reasoned arguments.

READING STRATEGY

Identify the author's perspective and purpose. Evaluate the quality of evidence. Consider whose voice is missing. Challenge assumptions and construct your own reasoned position.

READ THE PASSAGE — READ IT 3 TIMES!

Democracy — government by the people, for the people — is **considered** the world's most effective political system.

Yet in recent decades, democratic **institutions** have faced unprecedented challenges from within. **Disinformation** — deliberately false information spread to deceive — has **undermined** public trust in media, science and government.

Voting **participation** is declining in many established democracies, particularly among young people aged 18-25.

The rise of **populist** leaders who claim to represent 'the people' against 'elites' has polarised communities in many nations.

Compulsory voting in Australia, however, has maintained **consistently** high participation — above 90% at every federal election.

Critics of compulsory voting argue that **forced** participation produces **uninformed** votes. Supporters counter that it ensures **governments** must appeal to all citizens, not just the most motivated or **privileged**.

VOCABULARY HELPER

- disinformation = false information deliberately spread to mislead
- institutions = established organisations or systems within society
- populist = appealing to ordinary people by claiming to oppose elites
- compulsory = required by law
- polarised = divided into two strongly opposing groups

WARM UP — BEFORE YOU READ

What do you think democracy means in practice, not just in theory? Write 2 sentences:

A — COMPREHENSION

1. What is disinformation and how does it affect democracy?

2. What is unusual about Australia's voting system?

3. What do critics of compulsory voting argue?

4. What do supporters of compulsory voting counter?

B — ANALYSIS AND EVALUATION

1. What perspective does the phrase 'government by the people, for the people' reflect? Whose definition is this?

2. The author presents both sides of compulsory voting. Do you think one side is more convincing? Why?

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Answer Guide (For Parent / Teacher Use)

Warm Up: Accept thoughtful personal definition.

A1. Deliberately false information — it undermines trust in media, science and government. A2. Compulsory voting — above 90% participation. A3. Forced participation produces uninformed votes. A4. It ensures governments must appeal to all citizens, not just the privileged.

B1. This is Abraham Lincoln's famous phrase — it reflects a Western liberal democratic perspective. Not all nations define democracy this way. B2. Accept personal reasoned position with evidence.

C: Undermined = gradually weakened/eroded — suggests a serious, deliberate threat. 'Yet' introduces contrast — signals that despite its reputation, democracy has problems — creates immediate tension.

High Five! You are a Super Reader! ✓
Colour a star each time you read the passage aloud:



EXTENSION ACTIVITY

Write an analytical essay comparing Australia's compulsory voting system to one country with voluntary voting. Which system better serves democratic ideals? Use evidence.

PARENT TIP

Discuss elections your child might know about.
Ask: 'Who do politicians represent? What should a citizen do to vote responsibly?'

TEACHER TIP

Connect to HASS. Students analyse the voting systems of 3 countries. Conduct a class mock election comparing compulsory vs voluntary voting results.

STUDENT REFLECTION

- [] I can analyse multiple perspectives on a complex political issue
- [] I can identify rhetorical techniques and explain their effect
- [] I can write a sustained argument that addresses a counter-argument